

CAREER PATHS

Experience in customer service roles and fluency in one or more foreign languages will help gain entry to this profession. It takes between two and five years in the job before achieving promotion to more senior roles, such as managing the cabin.

HIGH SCHOOL

GRADUATE If you have a good school education, you can apply for cabin-crew training programs run by the major airlines.

GRADUATE

You do not need a degree to work as a cabin-crew member, but undergraduate study in travel, leisure, and tourism, hospitality management, languages, social science, or business may be helpful.



AIRLINE CABIN CREW

You take up your first job after completing training in areas including passenger care, customer relations, and security, customs, and immigration regulations. With experience, you can be promoted to a senior cabin-crew or ground-support job.



LANGUAGES

SPECIALIST Works as part of the cabin crew on long-haul flights in which a good knowledge of specific languages is required.



PURSER/SENIOR CABIN CREW

MEMBER Manages part of the cabin on an aircraft—such as the first-class lounge—and oversees other staff. Chief pursers are responsible for managing the whole aircraft.



VIP CABIN CREW

STAFF Looks after very important and prestigious passengers onboard either commercial aircraft or private jets.



CABIN CREW SUPPORT

Supports the work of cabin crew through roles including training, recruitment, and human resources. This role is generally only available to highly experienced cabin crew.

SKILLS GUIDE



Good communication skills for understanding and attending to passengers' needs.



The ability to work efficiently and supportively with colleagues in usually cramped cabin conditions.



Excellent customer service to deal with passengers in a polite, professional, and sensitive manner.



Good numerical skills for handling and exchanging foreign currency during in-flight shopping.



Being able to think quickly to keep passengers calm during difficulties, such as emergency landings.



Physical stamina and resilience to deal with jet lag and remain on duty for long hours in the cabin.